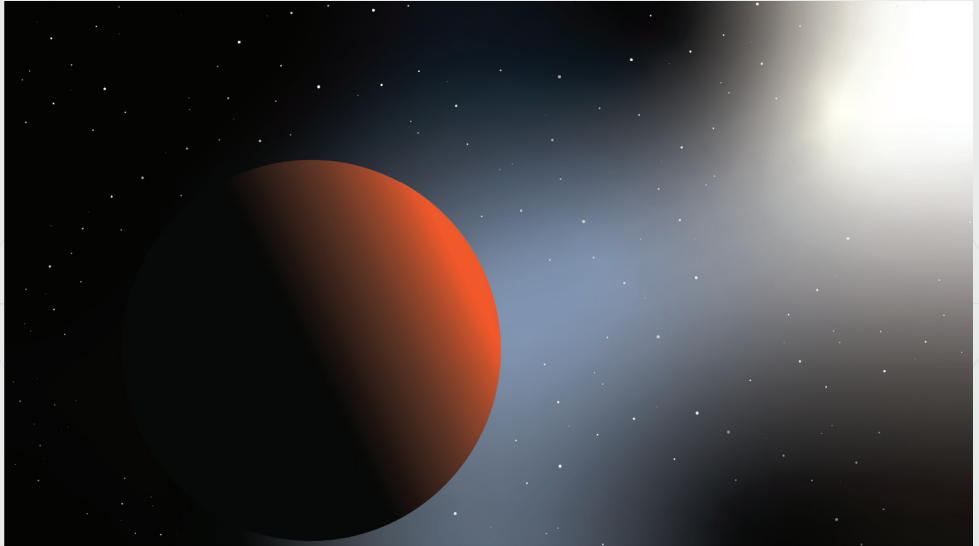




MARS

DESIGNED BY: EDUARDO AYUSO



The Next Frontier

Years of effort and resources spent towards research on Mars have finally paid off. A new resource seeming to be the key for assuring the future of space travel and colonization has been found, its name: Aresium. 15 times more powerful than the latest rocket fuel developed, Aresium promised a new era in mankind history, a new era beyond the Milky Way.

Soon enough, companies and governments around the world recognized the potential value of Aresium. They began investing heavily in space technology and mining operations, and in no time the once peaceful red planet became a lawless place. Paramilitary forces were deployed by the companies that established on Mars to ensure control over the valuable resource.

It wasn't long before the various corporations began to fight, transforming Mars into a battleground for unimaginable wealth and power.

Game Overview

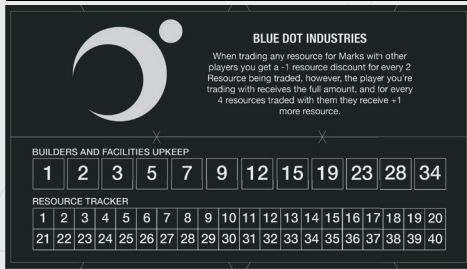
MARS is a strategic board game where players take on the roles of companies competing to exploit the valuable resource Aresium on the red planet. Players must manage their sources, personnel, and build the necessary infrastructure to extract Aresium, as well as to protect their mines from rival companies who will stop at nothing to gain advantage.

Throughout the game, players must also make strategic decisions to achieve their corporate goals, while keeping an eye on their competitors.

Who will come out on top in the race for Aresium and become the most powerful company in this new era of space exploration? Play MARS to find out!

For 2-4 Players.

Game Components



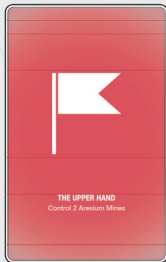
6 Corporation Sheets



19 Map Tiles



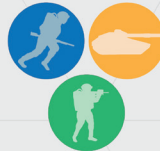
58 Battle Cards



17 Goal Cards



22 Discovery Tokens



324 Acrylic Unit Tokens
(54 per player [6])



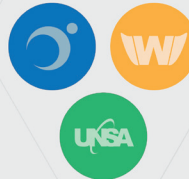
6 Acrylic HQ Tokens



72 Acrylic Building Tokens
(12 per player)



18 Resource Disks



6 Acrylic Outpost Tokens



6 Acrylic Influence Points Tokens



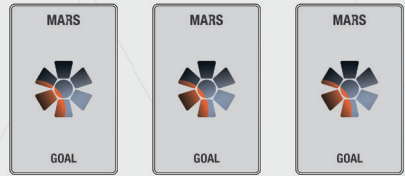
1 Game Mat



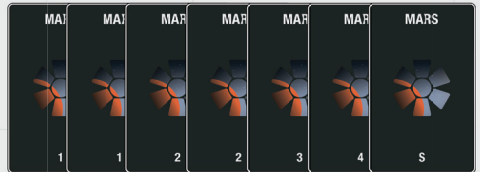
30 Heart Tokens

Setup

- Play Area:** Place the game mat on your play area in a way that it is accessible to every player along with the Heart tokens.
- Select Corporation:** Each player selects a corporation sheet and takes their corresponding Unit tokens, HQ tokens, and Building tokens.
- Construct Goal Decks:** Shuffle all Goal cards and place them upside down on the game mat, each player takes three and keeps them secret.
- Construct Battle Decks:** Separate all Battle cards by their backs: 1, 2, 3, 4, and S. Then shuffle them all separated by the number written on the back of them. One player has to:
 - Deal 2 cards facing down with the number 1 to each player.
 - Deal 2 cards facing down with the number 2 to each player.
 - Deal 1 card facing down with the number 3 to each player.
 - Deal 1 card facing down with the number 4 to each player.
 - Deal 1 card facing down with the letter S to each player.
 Each player should have 7 Battle cards.
- Tracking Resources:** To track resources each player should have three different resource disks: Yellow for Aresium, Blue for water, and Grey for metal.
 - As players gain and spend resources they must keep track of their Marks, Aresium and Water on the resource tracker section on their respective corporate sheets.
- Construct the Map:** The map tiles are used to construct the map. Separate the map tiles that have the Aresium resource in them from the rest and shuffle them looking upside down. Select three, and looking down, place them on the marked mat spaces "Aresium Map Tiles". Then Shuffle the rest of map tiles and place them upside down on a corner of

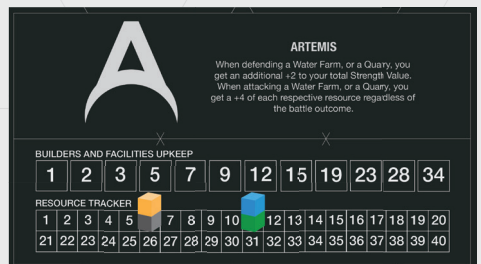


Each player's goal deck should look like this.



Each player's battle deck should look like this.

This showcases how a resource tracker section on a corporate sheet should look like if the player playing artemis had 6 Aresium, 6 Metal, 11 Marks and 11 Water.



the game mat.

- As players go through their turns, units will be moved onto mat spaces where there are no tiles. Every time a unit lands on an empty mat space a player can take a map tile and position it on the game mat as they find it more convenient. Map tiles also have hexes with encircled areas, on top of these players should add a Discovery token, which can be revealed once a unit reaches such hex. After a unit moves into a new a map tile, such unit cannot continue to discover more, even if their Move value allows them to.
 - This way the map will be generated until there are no more tiles to take from the stack.
7. **Build on the Map:** The map tiles will be separated in hexes, and in some of these hexes there will be three different types of squared icons. Such icons are to let the players know that they can construct buildings on such Hexes.
- The icons will be the same color as the resource disks: Yellow, Blue and Grey; and they will represent in the same way Aresium, Water and Metal correspondingly.
 - To construct such buildings, the players must first deploy Builder Units. Once the Builder Units reach the Hex with the desired icon a player can immediately substitute such Builder unit token with a Building token.
 - Once a Building token has been placed on the board, there will be an upkeep amount to pay for buildings, the amount will be stated on the builders and facilities upkeep section on each player's corporate sheet.

Playing the Game

MARS is played over a series of rounds split into different phases: Deployment, Movement/Building, Battle and Upkeep/Resource Collection.



The upper image showcases the Blue player's HQ in the middle of the Elysium map tile. He has two units, a Recon (top) and a Builder (bottom).

To the right of the Elysium map tile there is an map tile looking down that contains Aresium, placed there during the game setup. Upwards there is an empty game mat space.

The lower image showcases the how the Blue player moved both his units 2 hexes respectively. The Recon unit revealed a new map tile: Aeolis. The Builder unit was substituted with a Building token and taken out of the board because it reached a hex with an Aresium resource icon. The Blue player had enough to pay for the building.



At the beginning of the game all players start with a Builder unit and 30 Marks, and in the beginning of each round, players receive a fixed amount of 2 Marks as revenue from “operations on Earth”.

The player who plays the Artemis corporation is the first player, they play the first turn of each round. Continuing clockwise until all players have taken their turn, one at a time.

Phase 1: Deployment

In the first round players start the game by first deploying their Head Quarters, referred to as HQs, on map tiles that are to be positioned on the predetermined starting mat spaces.

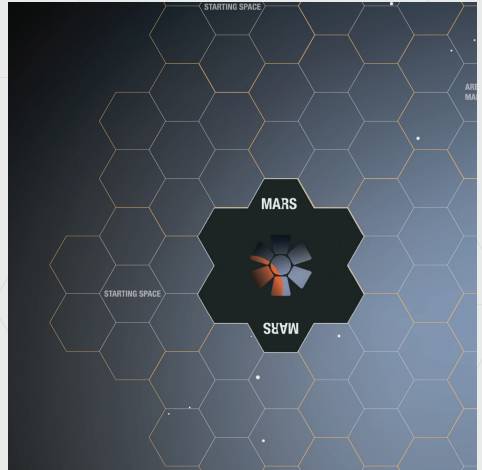
Depending on the amount of players, the location in which each player will start will change.

From there, and each round, players may deploy any type and amount of units they consider appropriate, and are able to afford.

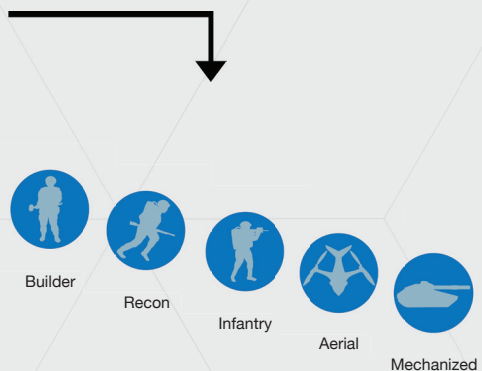
When deploying units it is important to consider certain characteristics such as their strength value, for battle, their move value, for movement across the map, and special information about them regarding what they can, and cannot do, and if they're affected by any type of terrain on the map.

The units available to be deployed are 5:

1. **Builder:** Its deployment price is 8 Marks. Its Move value is 3 hexes, and it does not have Strength value. It is immune to red valley's Radiation and to sand dunes' slow down. It is the only Unit that can share Hex with other friendly Units apart from the Aerial Unit.
2. **Recon:** Its deployment price is 4 Marks. Its Move value is 4 hexes, and its Strength value is 2 + battle card bonus. It is immune to sand dunes' slow down and can cross mountains if supplied with 1 water each Hex. The unit shall be supplied too, if such unit is on stand-by on a mountain hex.
3. **Infantry:** Its deployment price is 6 Marks. Its Move value is 3 hexes, and its Strength value is 4 + battle card bonus. It's affected by both sand dune's slowdown and red



Predetermined starting mat spaces will be marked with a watermark. Players are to position their first map tiles on this mat spaces so that the map gets equally distributed.



valley radiation, unless it's supplied with 1 Metal when spending a round on a red valley hex to countermeasure said radiation.

4. **Aerial:** Its deployment price is 8 Marks. Its Move value is 5, and it does not have strength value. It can cross all types of terrain, including mountains, and can carry another unit through them by sharing hex.
5. **Mechanized:** Its deployment price is 10 Marks. Its Move value is 2, and its Strength value is 8 + battle card bonus. It is immune to red valley Radiation, but it cannot move through sand dunes unless it's powered by 1 Aresium each Hex. The unit shall be supplied too, if such unit is on stand-by on a Sand Dune.

They can deploy such units on any hex surrounding their HQs, with the exemption of mountain terrain hexes. This includes the Builder unit every player starts the game with.

Players can also deploy units on their Outpost, once they have built such building.

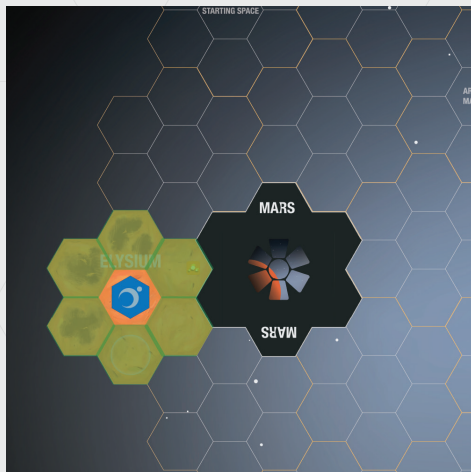
For a unit to be deployed, the hex in which it is to be deployed has to be empty. No units can share hex with neither other friendly or unfriendly units, unless it is a Builder or an Aerial unit.

Phase 2: Movement/Building

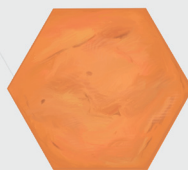
Starting with the player who plays the Artemis corporation and continuing clockwise each player may move their units according to each unit's unique Move value and terrain effects.

There are 4 different types of terrain on the 19 map tiles, and they all have their own effects:

1. **Sand Plains:** Units can cross this terrain type without being affected at all.
2. **Sand Dunes:** Units get a -1 hex to their Move value if they land on a sand dune terrain hex, unless stated otherwise on the characteristics of the unit.
3. **Red Valley:** Units get half of their Strength value reduced if they spend one round on a red valley hex, unless stated otherwise on



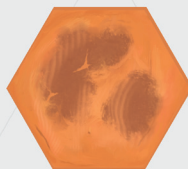
The Blue player can deploy units on any hex surrounding their HQ. Since there are no mountains terrain hexes surrounding the Blue player's HQ, it means they have 6 hexes available for deployment.



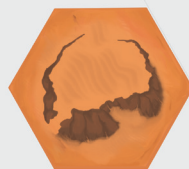
Sand Plain Hex



Sand Dune Hex



Red Valley Hex



Mountain Hex

the characteristics of the unit. To mark the loss or gain of Strength value in-game players must use the Heart tokens. Each Heart Token with a - sign on it is half Strength value lost, and with a + sign on it is half Strength value gained.

Once a unit reaches 0 in Strength value, such unit is defeated and has to be taken out of the map.

4. **Mountains:** Units cannot cross this type of terrain, unless stated otherwise on the characteristics of the unit.

Players may also decide not to move their units at all, leaving them on stand-by.

When a unit crosses into an empty mat space, the player who owns such unit may take one tile from the stack of tiles previously created during the game setup to position it on the map where their unit is moving and as they find it convenient.

Once the map tile has been positioned, it cannot be changed.

During this phase players may also spend any amount of resources to improve the movement of their units across different terrains individually. For example supplying Recon units with water for them to be able to cross mountains, or Mechanized units with Aresium for them to cross sand dunes.

During this Phase, if a Builder unit reaches a suitable hex for a building, then the player who owns such unit can construct on such hex according to the type of icon on the map tile, and if such player can afford said building. This is done by taking the Builder unit out of the map, and substituting it with a Building token, which has to be placed on top of the icon a player wishes to construct on.

The buildings available to be built are 4 and constructing them implies the following information:

1. **Water Farm:** The construction price for the first Water Farm each player builds is 2 Marks, for the second Water Farm is 4 Marks, and for the third Water Farm is 8, and



Aresium can be supplied to Mechanized units to cross Sand Dune terrain hexes.

This icon also represents hexes in which players can construct Aresium Mines.



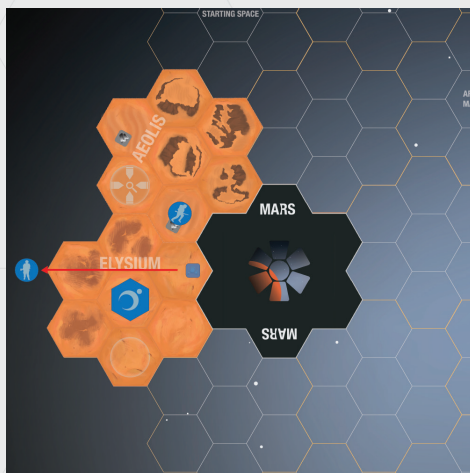
Water can be supplied to Recon units to cross Mountain hexes.

This icon also represents hexes in which players can construct Water Farms.



Metal can be supplied to Infantry units to countermeasure Red Valley Radiation.

This icon also represents hexes in which players can construct Quarries.



Here the Blue player has taken out of the map the Builder unit token, and has placed a Building token on top of the Aresium icon, meaning he has now constructed an Aresium Mine.

so on if applicable.

2. **Quarry:** The construction price for the first Quarry each player builds is 2 Water, for the second Quarry is 4 Water, and for the third Quarry is 6 Water, and so on if applicable.
3. **Aresium Mine:** The construction price for the first Aresium Mine each player builds is 2 Water + 4 Metal, for the second Aresium Mine is 4 Water + 6 Metal, and for the third Aresium Mine is 8 Water + 10 Metal, and so on if applicable.
4. **Outpost:** Players can only build one outpost per game. The construction price for an Outpost is 8 Marks, but instead of being constructed by a Builder, it has to be constructed by a military unit such as a Recon unit, Infantry unit, or Mechanized unit. Just like Builder units, once an Outpost is constructed, the military unit used for its construction has to be taken out of the map. The outpost can be constructed on any hex that does not have resources in them, and that is not mountain or red valley terrain. The players do not need to pay for an Outpost upkeep.

The Outpost is a building that provides +1 Strength to friendly adjacent units engaging in battle if empty or +2 Strength if occupied by friendly units from up to 1 Hex away from an enemy unit, but it cannot not defend or attack by itself.

The action of constructing a building (substituting a Builder unit token with a Building token) does not consume move value.

Phase 3: Battle

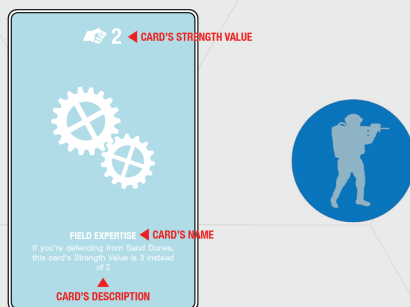
Starting with the player who plays the Artemis corporation and continuing clockwise each player may decide to engage in battle if their units are on adjacent hexes to another player's units by simply stating their intention to move their units into the hex being occupied by the other player.

In simple words, players fight over the control of one hex.

Each battle card has a name, a description and a number. The number is the added Strength value to your unit(s) Strength Value, the description is the immediate effect they cause on battle, and the name is for the identification of the card.



Here the Blue player has moved its Recon unit 2 hexes, revealing the previously looking down predetermined map tile containing Aresium, and proceeded to construct an Outpost, taking out the Recon unit of the map, placing down an Outpost Token.



The Field Expertise battle card showed above to the left has a Strength value of 2. The Infantry unit to the right has a Strength value of 4. If the Blue player defends from on another player standing a Sand Dune terrain hex with such Infantry unit and battle card then his total Strength value would be 7, result number from adding both the unit's and the battle card's Strength values the effect of the battle card's description.

Example 1: The Yellow player intends to move its infantry unit into a hex where the Blue player has another infantry unit stationed. The Yellow player lets the Blue player know that they are attacking. Both players are engaged in battle now, and both their units have a Strength value of 4; meaning it's a draw. To resolve this and any other battle players will use battle cards, both players will pick one of the battle cards on their hands, and will reveal them at the same time. The Strength value of each card will be added to the Strength value of their units and this will decide which player wins numerically, but the cards' descriptions may ultimately change the outcome of the battle.

When in battle, 6 Units are the maximum amount of attackers a defender can take (the total adjacent hexes to one hex), this if such defender is completely alone. However, this situation would be extremely impractical and not beneficial to the defender, with its odds of winning being almost non-existent. In addition, when attacking with more than 1 unit, only 1 unit can move into the hex upon which there was a battle victory.

Example 2: 1 single Green unit is surrounded by 6 Blue units. The Green unit is a Mechanized unit, and its Strength value is 8, additionally the Green player uses a 4 Strength value card, and this sums up a total of 12 Strength value. — The Blue units are all Recon units, and their summed Strength value is 12, but the Blue player also uses a 4 Strength value card, and this sums up a total of 16 Strength value. Numerically, the Blue player wins, but the sole description of the cards may change the outcome of the battle.

Similarly, when there are multiple opponent units ready for battle, then each of the units must at least have 1 contender.

- Example 3: There are 2 Green units with 3 Blue units adjacent to them, and all units, Green and Blue are Infantry Units. In this case 1 of the Green units will defend against 1 Blue unit, but the other Green unit will have to defend against 2 Blue units, this can be decided by the defender player. In this case



Example 1: Green player attacks Blue player, numerically, and considering only units, Green player wins. But when considering battle cards, Blue player wins.



Example 2: Green player defends with a Mechanized unit against Blue player, who is attacking with 6 Recon units. Numerically, and considering only units, Blue player wins, it is 8 Strength value against 12 Strength value. Although Green player's battle card description provided them with extra +2 Strength value, Blue player still wins, by 2 Strength Value.

By the end of the battle, only 1 Blue unit will be able to enter the hex in which Green player had its Mechanized unit.

scenario there cannot be 3 Green units attacking 1 single Blue unit because there is another Blue Unit keen to battle that cannot be left unattended.

Therefore, there has to be 2 battles: 1v1 and 1v2. For each battle, each of the players will use 2 different battle cards. In the 1v1 battle, both Blue and Green players have more or less the same probability of winning, and the result will depend on the battle cards. In the 1v2 battle, the Red player has more probabilities of winning numerically, but once again the result might be affected by the description of the battle cards.

To know if a unit can join another unit for battle, they need to fulfill the following conditions: Being adjacent to the friendly unit attacking or defending, and being adjacent to the contending unit attacking or defending.

In addition, when a unit enters a hex with an unprotected building or builder on it, that does not belong to the player whose unit just entered said hex, such building or builder passes to be owned by the player who entered this hex. Players that take over other player's building do not need to pay upkeep for them; and players that lost buildings can stop paying upkeep for them as well.

Phase 4: Upkeep/Resource Collection

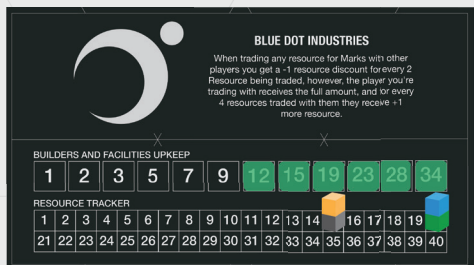
Starting with the player who plays the Artemis corporation and continuing clockwise each player will:

- Collect 2 Marks as revenue from Earth operations.
- Collect resources generated by their owned buildings. Each Water Farm provides 2 Water per round, each Quarry provides 2 Metal per round, and each Aresium Mine provides 1 Aresium per round.
- Pay for the upkeep of their buildings. The upkeep amount to pay will be stated on the builders and facilities upkeep section on each player's corporate sheet.

It is during this phase that players may also trade Aresium, Water and Metal for Marks with the game, or with other players.



Example 3: Green player will defend against Blue player. Blue player has 3 Infantry units, and Green player only has 2. One of the Green units will have to defend against 2 Blue units, while the other one will defend against 1 Blue unit. Since there are two battles taking place, each player will use two battle cards, one for each battle, and one after the other one.



Here the player that plays Blue Dot Industries has to pay an upkeep of 9 Marks by the end of each round, as the last Builder token placed on the board revealed number 9 on the Builders and Facilities upkeep.

When trading with the game there will be a fixed rate for trading, this being:

- 1 Aresium for 6 Marks.
- 4 Water for 6 Marks.
- 6 Metal for 6 Marks

Players cannot trade Marks for Aresium, Water or Metal, unless such trade is made with other players.

When players trade among themselves, they can use the fixed rate for trading, but that would not incentivize trading between players. Therefore each player can individually offer different rates according to what they find more convenient.

In the same way, players are not obliged to only trade Marks for Aresium, Water or Metal. If they wish, they may trade one resource for another without involving the use of Marks.

Winning the Game

To win the game, a player must achieve all the three goal cards they acquired during the game setup.

If no player achieves their goal cards, then the winner will be the player with most influence points. There is no time limit, or round limit stating the duration of the game. Players decide when the game shall end.

Influence Points

Influence points are gained by performing actions in the game. Each action provides a different amount of Influence Points:

- For each Aresium Mine constructed, a player will receive 3 Influence Points.
- For each Water Farm constructed, a player will receive 2 Influence Points.
- For constructing an Outpost , a player will receive 2 Influence Points.
- For each victory in battle, a player will receive 2 Influence Points.
- For each Quarry constructed, a player will receive 1 Influence Point.
- For each map tile revealed, a player will receive 1 Influence Point.

- For each defeat in battle a player will receive 1 Influence Point.
- For each trade action with another player, a player will receive 1 Influence Point.



The influence Points Tracker in on the game mat, players should move their respective tokens as they perform actions during the game.



MARS